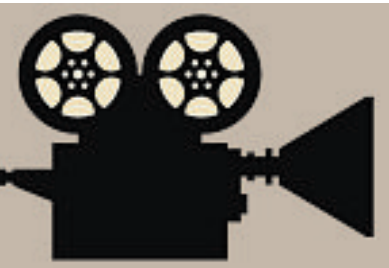




FALL ARTS 2025
SCREENS
PREVIEW
A look ahead at what's coming in movies, television and streaming. **A+E**





LIFE+TRAVEL
The spirit of the Gullah Geechee
Elders in St. Helena Island, S.C., work to preserve sacred songs, "a language of survival" passed down by Black enslaved ancestors.

What may lie ahead for Chicago

Trump's takeover of Washington offers insights on what could be in store

By **Daniel C. Vock**
Chicago Tribune

WASHINGTON — Along the streets of the nation's capital, signs planted in front yards exclaim "Free DC," neighbors keep watch to ensure immigrant children walking to school are protected, and short bike rides are routinely interrupted by sightings of federal agents milling about and troops carrying guns.

The fight for control over Washington's streets these days is not — as President Donald Trump portrays it — much of a clash between law enforcement and would-be criminals. Instead, it's

INSIDE: With a potential federal crackdown becoming more possible, Mayor Brandon Johnson signed a wide-ranging executive order Saturday that includes urging federal law enforcement to not wear masks in Chicago. **Page 2**
■ Will trust be a casualty of federal crackdown? Critics fear agents' actions are eroding gains made by local authorities. **Nation & World**

mostly between the swarms of federal agents and troops disrupting everyday life in the district and the vast majority of city residents who want them to go away.
Now, as the prospect of Trump

sending a surge of federal forces to Chicago rises daily, the Washington occupation provides insights into what a Chicago incursion could entail. What Chicago experiences is unlikely to be exactly like what's happening in Washington and might, in fact, more closely resemble Trump's efforts several months ago in Los Angeles, but there are clear parallels between the Washington takeover and what Trump appears to have planned for Chicago.

The Republican president has repeatedly criticized both Washington and Chicago — Democratic

Turn to Takeover, Page 4



Activists participate in a rally in Washington, D.C., on Thursday. The rally was paired with a march to mark Labor Day and protest the federal law enforcement surge in the nation's capital. **ALEX WONG/GETTY**



Pedro Martinez, from left, Darrin Stoller, 11, and Paul Kilgus talk while milking cows at Kilgus Farmstead in Fairbury on July 31. Kilgus Farmstead is one of 18 farms permitted to sell raw milk in Illinois, but it can only be sold on the farm where it was produced. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Risks of raw milk

Massive Illinois salmonella outbreak 40 years ago highlights perils as nation debates unpasteurized dairy

By **Angie Leventis Lourgos**
Chicago Tribune

Influencer content promoting the consumption of raw milk has grown prolific online, even as outbreaks of foodborne illnesses linked to unpasteurized dairy have recently sickened consumers across the country.
Social media personas like Ballerina Farm's Hannah Neeleman and Lauryn Bosstick of The Skinny Confidential routinely claim benefits from drinking milk that hasn't been pasteurized. A video of Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. doing raw milk "shooters" in the White House with podcaster Dr. Paul Saladino, dubbed the "carnivore MD," went viral in May.
And another popular influencer offers a particularly wild take on pasteurization stemming from a

Chicago-area case of large-scale foodborne illness that plagued the nation 40 years ago.
A raw milk enthusiast known as Gubba Homestead, who has roughly 2 million followers on Instagram, claims in a video that one of the largest salmonella outbreaks in the United States, which originated at an Illinois farm in 1985, actually stemmed from pasteurized milk.
"Not raw milk," the content creator concludes before taking a big gulp from a glass of milk that's presumably unpasteurized.
The brief recording highlighted a scary time in Chicago-area history: Four decades ago, a multistate salmonella epidemic traced to milk from a Melrose Park farm sickened an estimated 168,000 to 197,000 people

Turn to Milk, Page 8

CHICAGO PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Budget passed — future still unclear

Important funding decisions ahead amid \$734 million deficit

By **Nell Salzman, Kate Perez and Alice Yin**
Chicago Tribune

A tense silence hung over the Chicago Board of Education on Thursday night as the roll call vote began.
Just hours earlier, community members had packed the room, urging the board to pass a 2025-26 budget that spared classrooms from cuts.
At the heart of the debate was a \$200 million high-interest loan and a disputed pension payment for nonteaching CPS staff members — both backed by Mayor Brandon Johnson, both left out of the district's proposal.
As Johnson-appointed board members Ed Bannon, District 1A, Anusha Thotakura, District 6A, and Cydney Wallace, District 8B, quietly broke ranks, gasps rippled through the crowded room. The final tally — 12 in favor, seven opposed, and one abstention — drew cheers.

The vote marked a public setback for Johnson, a former Chicago Teachers Union organizer navigating the shift from movement politics to municipal governance. It also exposed the political fragility of the city's hybrid school board — long championed by progressives as a vehicle for equity, now emerging as a challenge to Johnson's authority.
"We have this unrealistic expectation that we'll always agree. And that's not how democracy works," said Bannon in an interview with the Tribune on Friday.
Board members Thotakura and Wallace declined to comment on their votes.
With major funding decisions

Turn to CPS, Page 6

Are you ready for some football?

■ A look at the players who made our Bears All-Quarter-Century Team. **Chicago Sports**
■ NFL preview with scouting reports and more. **Special section in subscribers' copies**

'It was a very messed-up river'

Cleanup efforts on 13 miles of the Grand Calumet River, which meanders across northwest Indiana, are making headway, but more work is needed. **Chicagoland, Page 3**